

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 25th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lr2Jkh03ehQ
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** [00:15:37](#) Municipal Budget Hearing. The council reconvened to review and finalize 2024 budget adjustments, focusing specifically on insurance changes in the Communications Department, Local Income Tax (LIT) funds, sheriff and jail budgets, and staffing requests.
- **Summary of Discussion:** The board reviewed updated figures from the auditor's office regarding health insurance adjustments, revenue projections, and specific departmental requests. Key areas of discussion included balancing LIT funds, funding rank changes for sheriff deputies, adjusting dispatcher salaries, adding a deputy prosecutor position, and addressing compensation for correctional officers.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order on September 25 (9/25) by the presiding officer as a budget hearing session following technical delays.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as President Piper ([00:38:20](#)).
 - **Board/Council Members Present:** Bill, Eugene, Ryan, and Dan (mentioned or participating via phone/discussion).

- **Other Officials:** Tanya (Auditor/Staff), Becky (Auditor/Staff), Matt (Staff), Fred (Communications Director), and the County Prosecutor.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in this transcript segment.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** None noted.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:16:08 Communications Department Insurance Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented with the auditor's office and staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed a 2% increase based on 2023 amounts, resulting in a total needed of \$331,500 for 2024<U+2014>a reduction of \$23,500 on that line item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Incorporated into budget revisions.
- **00:18:18 Local Income Tax (LIT) & Public Safety Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor and board members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed increases in LIT funds due to insurance selections and staffing changes (e.g., prosecutor's office receptionist moving to investigator). The board debated whether LIT funds needed to be balanced to the exact penny, ultimately agreeing to leave certain overages and shift funds to pensions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adjusted LIT allocations and moved \$70,000 from County Council LIT sheriff's pension to Merit Board pension.
- **00:47:16 Sheriff's Department Rank Structure Changes**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed rank structure updates moving one Corporal to Sergeant and one Lieutenant to Captain, amounting to flat-rate promotions plus FICA and PERF.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:05:15 9-1-1 Communications Dispatcher Salary Increases**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications Director) / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Fred requested funding to support a \$3,000 raise plan for 29 dispatchers over a multi-year agreement, noting health insurance savings and Muncie contract revenue offsets. After debate, the board agreed to fund a \$2,000 increase per dispatcher.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to allocate a \$2,000 increase per dispatcher.
- **01:34:27 Prosecutor's Office Additional Deputy Position**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Prosecutor / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The prosecutor argued a critical workload need for an additional deputy prosecutor position, referencing public defender caseload standards and heavy trial burdens. Despite initial hesitations regarding growing government, the board recognized the critical need.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to fund an additional deputy prosecutor position including family health insurance, FICA, and PERF.
 - **02:05:21 Drainage Board Coordinator Salary Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eugene (Council Member).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Eugene proposed lowering a proposed 10% raise for the drainage board coordinator position from \$46,200 down to \$42,400 to free up funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adjusted by consensus.
 - **02:10:46 Jail / Correctional Officers Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board members and Sheriff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed providing additional salary adjustments for correctional officers who missed out on prior adjustments compared to outside agencies. After reviewing remaining funds and operating balances, the board agreed on a \$750 adjustment for correctional officers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general citizen open forum or public comment period from members of the general public was conducted during this budget work session; substantive input was restricted to department heads (Sheriff, Prosecutor, Communications Director).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Due to extensive adjustments to 101 employee records, the budget adoption date is required to be pushed back by a couple of weeks, requiring re-advertising according to DLGF guidelines.
 - A council member noted they will be attending a family event out of town during the scheduled Friday adoption meeting but will monitor virtually and provide proxy/email votes as permitted.
 - **Adjournment:** The hearing concluded with plans to meet the following morning at council and finalize processes **02:28:07**.
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